Infobits

Hints of life:

The Precambrian was the age of microorganisms. They were macroscopically expressed in a colonial structure called **stromatolite**. It is a layer produced by live or fossilized mats of photosynthetic prokaryotes (cyanobacteria) associated with warm lagoons or hot springs. The ancient **stromalite** belongs to anoxygenic phototrophic filamentous bacteria and modern **stromalite** belongs to oxygenic photo trophic cyanobacteria.

Protista: This kingdom includes eukaryotic unicellular Protozoans, slime molds and algae. The kingdom is made up of more than 250000 species. These organisms have typical eukaryotic cell organization.

Fungi: This kingdom includes non green, non photosynthetic eukaryotic fungi. molds, mushroom, toad stools, puffballs and bracket fungi are grouped under this kingdom. They are multicellular and consist of specialized eukaryotic cells arranged in a filamentous form.

Plantae: It includes all multicellular plants of land and water. They use photosynthesis to synthesize their organic molecules.

Animalia: This kingdom includes all multicellular eukaryotic animals. They are also referred to as Metazoans. Animals ingest their food through one of any ingestion portal and then use digestive enzymes to break food particles into absorbable fragments (Figure 8.3).

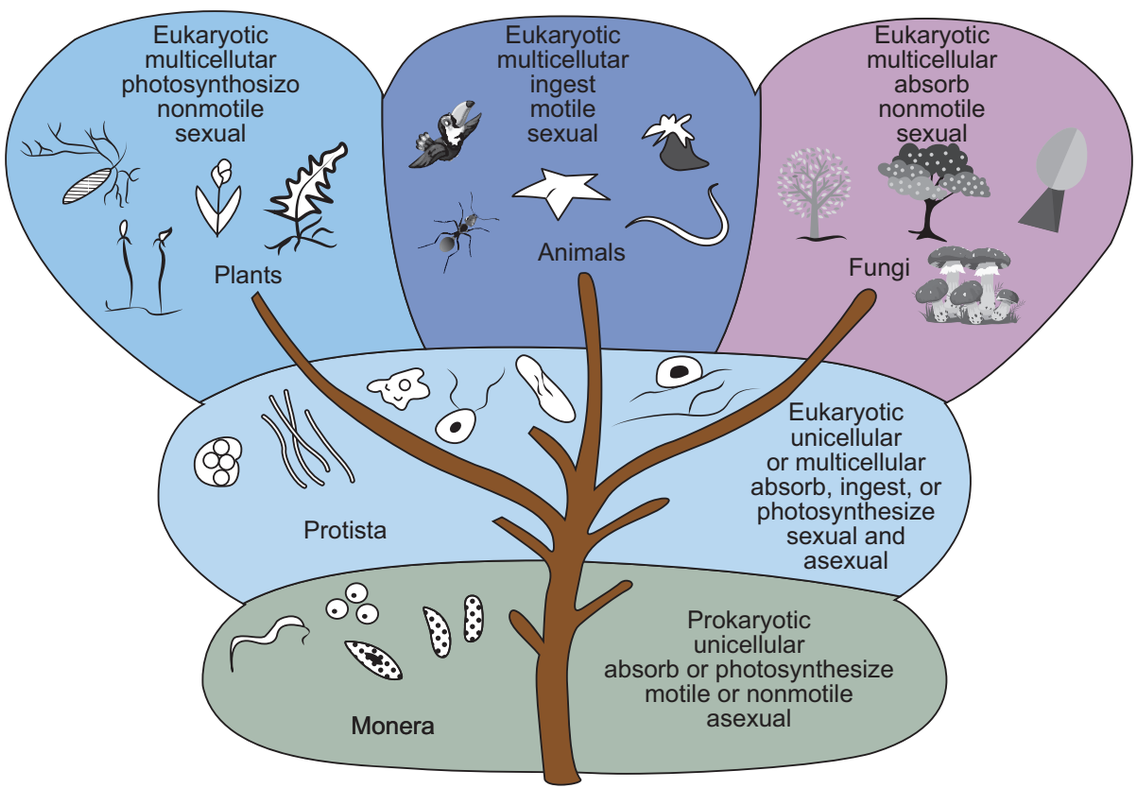


Figure 8.3: Whittaker's Five Kingdom classification

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